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Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

READING CHECK: "BISCUIT" AND "THE REEDS OF THE NORTH LAGOON"

Version B

Read the story and the article. Then answer each question. Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

Biscuit

Fiction · Written for this quiz.

1 Mrs. Abara handed Kiran her spare key and a page of notes. "Biscuit is shy with new people, so don't take it personally," she said. At the bottom she had written: Dev will come Thursday to water the plants. Kiran had asked his parents for a pet for three years. Four days with Biscuit felt like a test, and he planned to get a perfect score.

2 On Monday morning the apartment was silent. Kiran filled the bowl and crouched by the couch. "Here, kitty, kitty!" He shook the food bag and tapped the bowl with a spoon, louder each time. He walked to school with his shoulders up near his ears.

3 That evening the bowl was empty, and the blanket on the armchair was warm and covered in orange hair. Kiran looked behind the mat. Nothing had spilled. At dinner his sister Tam said, "So she ate!" Kiran shook his head. "Dev must have come by and tossed it out. She won't touch anything I give her."

4 On Tuesday he tried harder. He waved a feather toy under the bed and sang to her. Two green eyes watched him from the dark, then slid away. "She misses Mrs. Abara too much to eat," he told Tam. "And she hates me." Tam shrugged. "Or you're loud."

5 On Wednesday evening Kiran had a math test to study for and no energy for singing. He sat on the floor against the couch, opened his notebook, and forgot to call her at all.

6 After a while, something warm leaned against his elbow. Biscuit sat beside him, staring at the page as if she were checking his work. Kiran did not reach for her. He kept writing, but slower. She stayed until he finished the last problem.

7 On Thursday, Dev was watering the plants when Mrs. Abara got home. She glanced at Kiran's notebook. "I used to teach math, you know." Kiran started to say, "She didn't eat at first," then looked at Dev and stopped. Biscuit was curled on the armchair, watching him. "Could I come over sometimes?" he asked. "I'd bring my homework."

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Questions 1-5: "Biscuit"

1. In paragraph 4, what does Tam think the problem is?

A. Biscuit misses her owner too much.

B. Kiran is making too much noise.

C. Biscuit is shy with people she doesn't know.

D. The feather toy frightens Biscuit.

2. In paragraph 3, why does Kiran shake his head at dinner?

A. He thinks Biscuit spilled most of it behind the mat.

B. He wants Tam to stop asking about Biscuit.

C. He believes someone else emptied Biscuit's bowl.

D. He thinks Biscuit ate only a few bites of it.

3. Part A: In paragraph 7, why does Kiran offer to bring his homework when he visits?

A. He hopes Biscuit will come sit by him again while he works.

B. He hopes Biscuit will let him pet her while he studies.

C. He thinks Biscuit likes being sung to while he works.

D. He thinks Biscuit is lonely without Mrs. Abara.

4. Part B: Which line from the story BEST supports your Part A answer?

A. "When he reached out, she rubbed her head on his hand." [6]

B. "He sang softly to her as he did his math." [5]

C. "She misses Mrs. Abara too much to eat," [4]

D. "She stayed until he finished the last problem." [6]

5. On Monday morning, what does Kiran do to get Biscuit to come out? Quote one sentence that shows it and give its paragraph number.

Answer: _____

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The Reeds of the North Lagoon

Nonfiction · Written for this quiz. Vessa Island, its people and its animals are invented.

1 Vessa Island has two shallow lagoons, North and South, with a strip of sand between them. Tall tolla reeds once grew thick along both shores. A long-legged gray bird called the drell nests only in thick reeds. At night it wades through the mud and eats kib snails.

2 In the winter of 1961, a storm flattened the reeds around the North Lagoon. The South Lagoon, behind higher dunes, lost only a few. With nowhere to nest, the North Lagoon's drells flew off. Some fishermen were glad. They believed drells ate young fish, though no one had ever seen one do it.

3 Everyone expected the reeds to come back in a year or two, as they had after smaller storms. They did not. Each spring, green shoots poked up from the mud, and each summer they were gone. Islanders blamed the salt the storm had washed in.

4 In 1968, a teacher named Hana Selk tested the North Lagoon's water and found it no saltier than the South's. Then she went out after dark with a lamp. The mud was crowded with kib snails, and they were eating the new shoots down to the roots. Without drells, almost nothing was eating the kibs.

5 The islanders first tried planting reeds by hand. The snails ate those too. So in 1971 Selk's students built wooden nesting platforms and hid them in the last reed clumps. Two pairs of drells moved in the next spring.

6 The change was slow. For five summers the shoots kept vanishing, and some islanders said the platforms were a waste of wood. By 1980, though, every platform was in use, the snails were thinner on the mud, and reeds stood again along the North Lagoon's shore.

7 The fishermen's catch did not drop when the drells came back. If anything, it rose. Young fish hide among reed stems.

8 Selk later wrote, "The storm knocked the reeds down. The missing birds kept them down."

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Questions 6-12: "The Reeds of the North Lagoon"

6. According to the article, who built the nesting platforms?

A. the fishermen of the North Lagoon

B. islanders from the South Lagoon

C. Hana Selk's students

D. Hana Selk and the fishermen

7. Why did the South Lagoon most likely lose only a few reeds in the 1961 storm?

A. Its higher dunes kept the worst of the storm away.

B. Its drells kept the hungry snails off the young shoots.

C. Its water was much less salty than the North Lagoon's.

D. Its reeds grew farther from the open sea.

8. The first drells moved onto the platforms in 1972, but the new shoots kept vanishing for years afterward. Based on the article, what most likely explains the delay?

A. Salt from the 1961 storm was still in the water.

B. Two pairs of drells were too few for all the kibs.

C. The new drells ate young fish, not kib snails.

D. The reed roots needed years to heal from the kibs.

9. Part A: What does the article suggest about the belief that drells ate young fish?

A. It was proved true by fishermen in 1960.

B. It was true, though the harm to the fish was small.

C. It led the fishermen to drive the drells away.

D. It was only a guess, with nothing to back it up.

10. Part B: Which line from the article BEST supports your Part A answer?

A. "They believed drells ate young fish, though no one had ever seen one do it." [2]

B. "In 1960, fishermen counted dozens of drells eating young fish." [1]

C. "The fishermen's catch did not drop when the drells came back." [7]

D. "The fishermen chased the last drells off with nets." [2]

11. Why does the article say the platforms were hidden in the last reed clumps?

A. because a storm like the one in 1961 might flatten them

B. because snails could not climb into thick reeds

C. because drells will nest only where reeds grow thick

D. because hunting birds might spot them

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12. What does "in use" mean as it is used in paragraph 6? Give one detail from another paragraph that shows it happening, and give the paragraph number.

Answer: _____

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (4 points)

Write your answer on the lines.

13. How does the way Kiran treats Biscuit change from Monday to Wednesday evening? Use RACE: R - Restate the question. A - Answer it. C - Cite two pieces of evidence with [paragraph numbers]. E - Explain how each piece of evidence proves your answer.

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